

Lithium

Global BEV sales +8% YoY in May but -3% YTD YoY; China BEV penetration remains at 42%

Key takeaways from the May EV sales data: (1) Global BEV sales (China + EU + US) rose 9% MoM to 938k units and are up 8% YoY but YTD remain down 3% vs 2025; global BEV penetration stood at 24% in May (vs 23% in Apr'26). (2) **China** BEV penetration remained elevated at 42% in May, with BEV sales rising 10% MoM to 637k units and total EV (BEV+PHEV) penetration reaching 63%, the highest since August 2025. (3) **US** BEV sales rebounded 10% MoM to 86k units but are still down 25% YTD YoY; BEV penetration continued to stand at 6%. (4) **EU-10** BEV sales increased 5% MoM to 214kt and remain up 32% YTD YoY; BEV penetration increased to 32% (from 24% in April). The EU remains the strongest region on country-level subsidy schemes and affordable mass EVs penetrating the market. With the continued strength in the ESS market and the supply time lag, we see modest upward pressure in spodumene prices from here. Our top pick in the lithium space is PLS. For more information on EV/PHEV sales, please see JPM's Asia Battery/Autos research teams' latest note [here](#).

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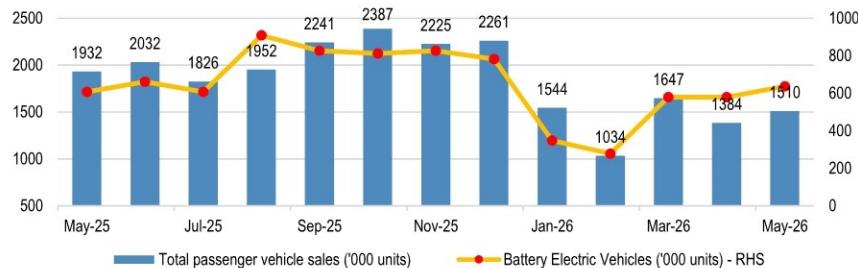
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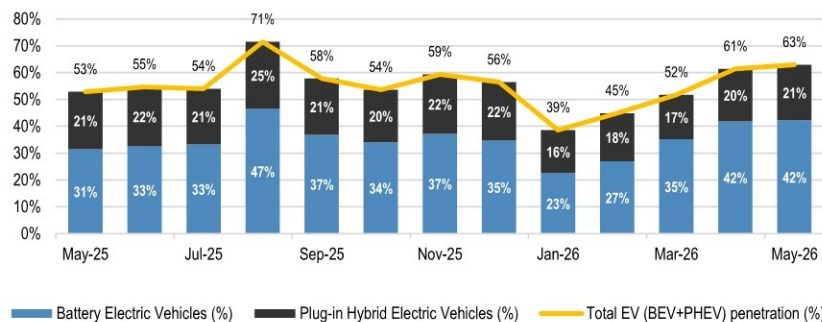
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Figure 1: China vehicle sales vs. BEV sales



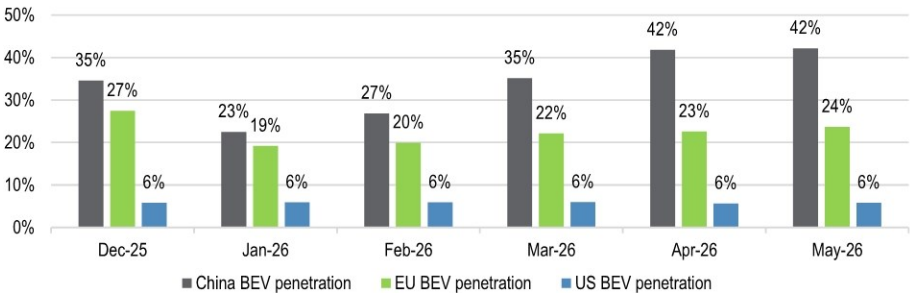
Source: China Passenger Car Association (CPCA), company data. Note: Our China data now references retail sales vs. wholesale sales previously.

Figure 2: China EV penetration rates



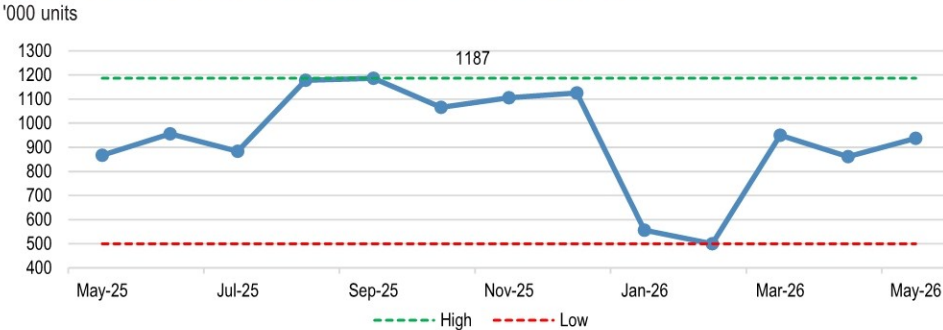
Source: China Passenger Car Association (CPCA), company data.

Figure 3: Battery electric vehicle penetration rates by region



Source: China Passenger Car Association (CPCA), company data, Motor Intelligence.

Figure 4: Battery electric vehicle sales – monthly (China + EU + US)



Source: China Passenger Car Association (CPCA), company data, Motor Intelligence.
Note: Our China data now references retail sales vs. wholesale sales previously.

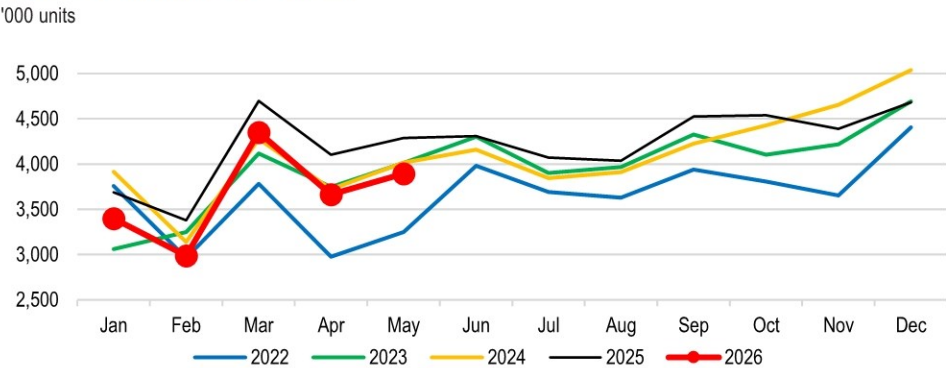
Figure 5: Global vehicle sales

	Global passenger vehicle sales	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26	Apr-26	May-26
China	Battery Electric Vehicles ('000 units)	607	661	607	908	826	812	827	782	348	278	579	579	637
	Total BEV sales ('000 units) - YTD	2,669	3,330	3,937	4,845	5,671	6,483	7,310	8,092	348	626	1,205	1,784	2,421
	Total BEV sales (Growth YTD YoY)	38%	37%	35%	39%	37%	35%	31%	28%	-19%	-27%	-20%	-13%	-9%
	Plug-in Hybrid Electric Vehicles ('000 units)	414	450	380	487	469	469	494	494	248	186	273	271	313
	Other Vehicles ('000 units)	911	921	839	557	946	1106	904	985	948	570	795	534	560
	Total passenger vehicle sales ('000 units)	1932	2032	1826	1952	2241	2387	2225	2261	1544	1034	1647	1384	1510
	Total vehicle sales (Growth YoY)	15%	15%	6%	2%	6%	6%	-9%	-14%	-14%	-25%	-15%	-23%	-22%
	Battery Electric Vehicles (%)	31%	33%	33%	47%	37%	34%	37%	35%	23%	27%	35%	42%	42%
	Plug-in Hybrid Electric Vehicles (%)	21%	22%	21%	25%	21%	20%	22%	22%	16%	18%	17%	20%	21%
	Total EV (BEV+PHEV) penetration (%)	53%	55%	54%	71%	58%	54%	59%	56%	39%	45%	52%	61%	63%
US	Battery Electric Vehicles ('000 units)	106	101	130	149	147	72	69	87	66	71	84	78	86
	Total BEV sales ('000 units) - YTD	515	616	746	895	1,042	1,115	1,184	1,271	66	136	220	298	385
	Total BEV sales (Growth YTD YoY)	3%	1%	4%	7%	11%	6%	1%	-3%	-30%	-30%	-28%	-27%	-25%
	Plug-in Hybrid Electric Vehicles ('000 units)	28	21	24	30	25	12	13	14	10	11	13	15	19
	Other Vehicles ('000 units)	1341	1158	1252	1302	1095	1200	1210	1387	1039	1114	1308	1287	1374
	Total passenger vehicle sales ('000 units)	1475	1280	1406	1480	1267	1284	1292	1488	1114	1196	1405	1380	1480
	Total vehicle sales (Growth YoY)	2%	-4%	9%	4%	7%	-4%	-6%	-2%	-1%	-4%	-11%	-6%	0%
	Battery Electric Vehicles (%)	7%	8%	9%	10%	12%	6%	5%	6%	6%	6%	6%	6%	6%
	Plug-in Hybrid Electric Vehicles (%)	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%
	Total EV (BEV+PHEV) penetration (%)	9%	10%	11%	12%	14%	7%	6%	7%	7%	7%	7%	7%	7%
Europe (EU-10)	Battery Electric Vehicles ('000 units)	154	195	146	122	213	182	209	257	142	151	287	204	214
	Total BEV sales ('000 units) - YTD	758	953	1,099	1,220	1,434	1,615	1,825	2,081	142	293	581	784	999
	Total BEV sales (Growth YTD YoY)	24%	22%	23%	23%	23%	24%	26%	29%	11%	14%	27%	30%	32%
	Plug-in Hybrid Electric Vehicles ('000 units)	89	102	91	68	116	99	97	104	82	80	132	101	105
	Other Vehicles ('000 units)	636	702	602	415	689	590	566	573	516	526	879	597	584
	Total passenger vehicle sales ('000 units)	880	999	839	605	1018	870	872	933	740	758	1298	901	904
	Total vehicle sales (Growth YoY)	-1%	-5%	2%	4%	10%	5%	4%	5%	-3%	1%	11%	7%	3%
	Battery Electric Vehicles (%)	18%	19%	17%	20%	21%	21%	24%	27%	19%	20%	22%	23%	24%
	Plug-in Hybrid Electric Vehicles (%)	10%	10%	11%	11%	11%	11%	11%	11%	11%	11%	10%	11%	12%
	Total EV (BEV+PHEV) penetration (%)	28%	30%	28%	31%	32%	32%	35%	39%	30%	31%	32%	34%	35%
Total	Battery Electric Vehicles ('000 units)	867	956	883	1178	1187	1066	1105	1125	556	500	950	861	938
	Battery Electric Vehicles (m units) - YTD	3,943	4,899	5,782	6,960	8,147	9,213	10,318	11,444	556	1,056	2,006	2,867	3,805
	BEV sales, YTD/YTD	29%	28%	28%	31%	30%	29%	26%	24%	-15%	-19%	-12%	-7%	-3%
	BEV growth YoY - China	23%	34%	26%	56%	28%	21%	9%	3%	-19%	-35%	-10%	4%	5%
	BEV growth YoY - US	-4%	-6%	18%	22%	43%	-32%	-42%	-36%	-33%	-28%	-25%	-23%	-18%
	BEV growth YoY - EU	14%	14%	33%	25%	20%	35%	42%	56%	11%	18%	44%	38%	39%
	BEV growth YoY - Total	17%	24%	26%	47%	28%	17%	8%	6%	-15%	-23%	-1%	7%	8%
	BEV growth MoM - Total	7%	10%	-8%	33%	1%	-10%	4%	2%	-51%	-10%	90%	-9%	9%
	Plug-in Hybrid Electric Vehicles ('000 units)	531	573	495	585	609	580	604	612	340	277	419	387	437
	Growth YoY	33%	25%	4%	14%	7%	-6%	-2%	-6%	-15%	-20%	-14%	-16%	-18%
Total	Other Vehicles ('000 units)	2,889	2,781	2,693	2,274	2,730	2,896	2,680	2,945	2,503	2,210	2,982	2,417	2,518
	Total passenger vehicle sales ('000 units)	4,287	4,310	4,071	4,037	4,526	4,541	4,389	4,683	3,398	2,987	4,351	3,665	3,893
	Total passenger vehicles (Growth YoY)	7%	4%	6%	3%	7%	3%	-6%	-7%	-8%	-12%	-7%	-11%	-9%
	Battery Electric Vehicles (%)	20%	22%	22%	29%	26%	23%	25%	24%	16%	17%	22%	23%	24%
	Plug-in Hybrid Electric Vehicles (%)	12%	13%	12%	14%	13%	13%	14%	13%	10%	9%	10%	11%	11%
	Total EV (BEV+PHEV) penetration (%)	33%	35%	34%	44%	40%	36%	39%	37%	26%	26%	31%	34%	35%
	Other Vehicles (%)	67%	65%	66%	56%	60%	64%	61%	63%	74%	74%	69%	66%	65%

Source: China Passenger Car Association (CPCA), company data, Motor Intelligence.
Note: Our China data now references retail sales vs. wholesale sales previously.

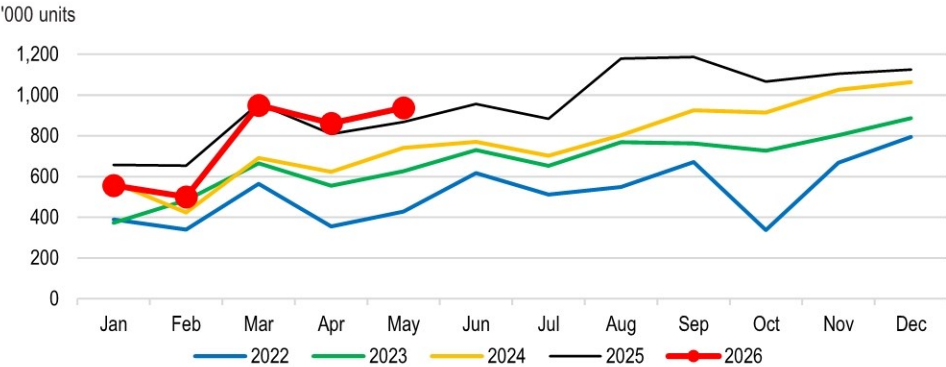
Global

Figure 6: Total vehicle sales – Global



Source: China Passenger Car Association (CPCA), company data, Motor Intelligence.

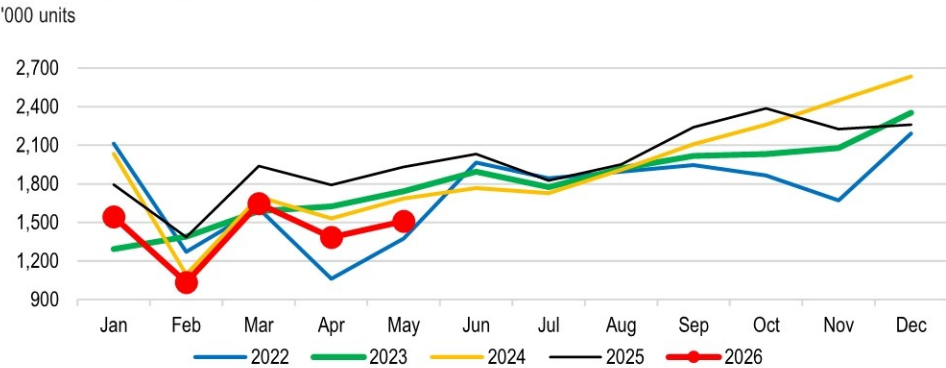
Figure 7: Battery electric vehicle sales – Global



Source: China Passenger Car Association (CPCA), company data, Motor Intelligence.

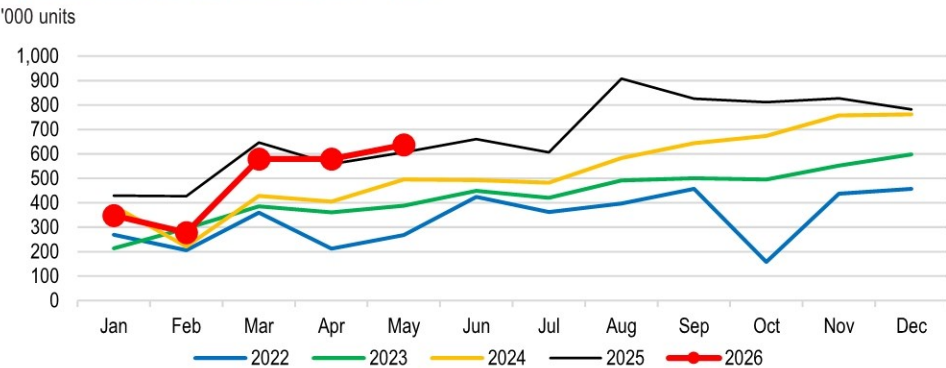
China

Figure 8: Total vehicle sales – China



Source: China Passenger Car Association (CPCA), company data, Motor Intelligence.

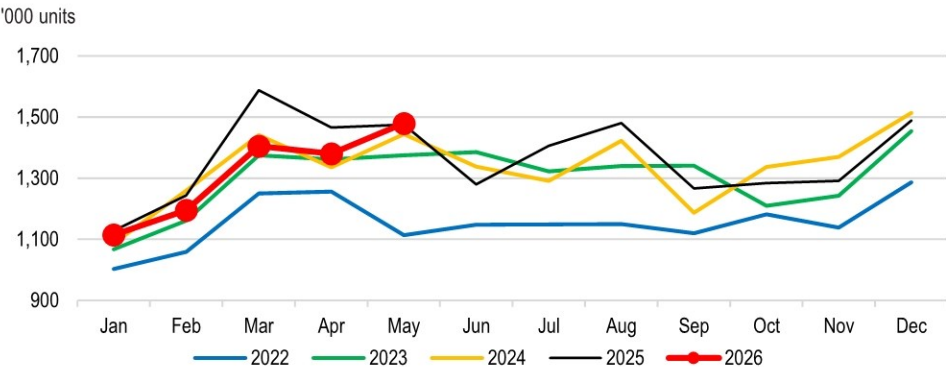
Figure 9: Battery electric vehicle sales – China



Source: China Passenger Car Association (CPCA), company data, Motor Intelligence.

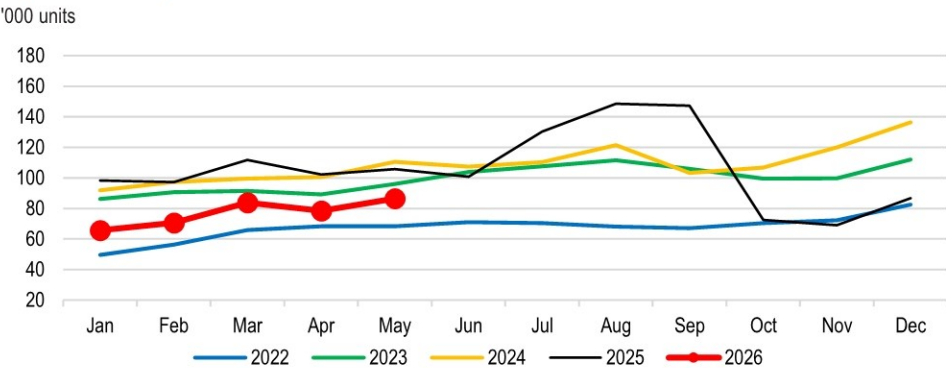
US

Figure 10: Total vehicle sales – US



Source: Company data, Motor Intelligence.

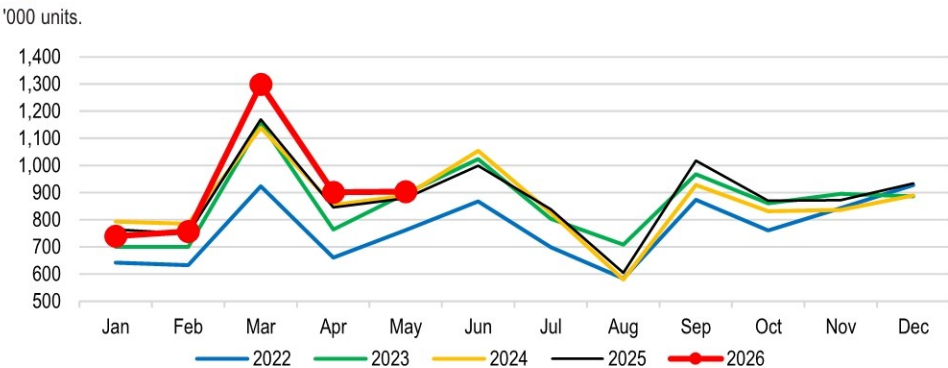
Figure 11: Battery electric vehicle sales – US



Source: Company data, Motor Intelligence.

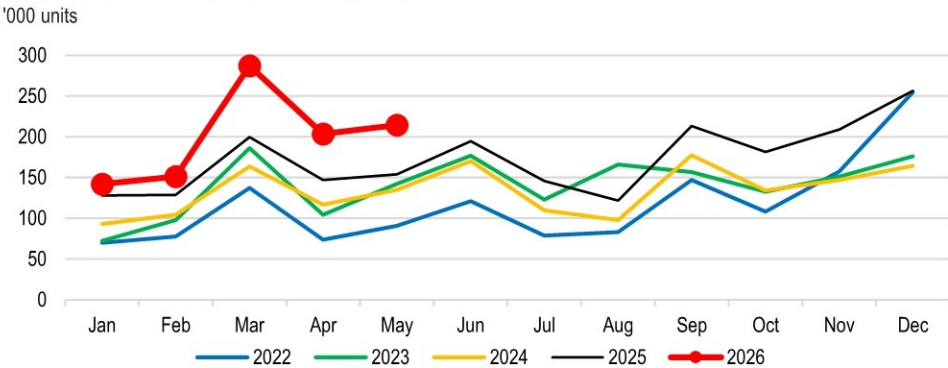
EU-10 (France, Germany, UK, Austria, Norway, Sweden, Switzerland, Italy, Spain, Netherlands)

Figure 12: Total vehicle sales – EU



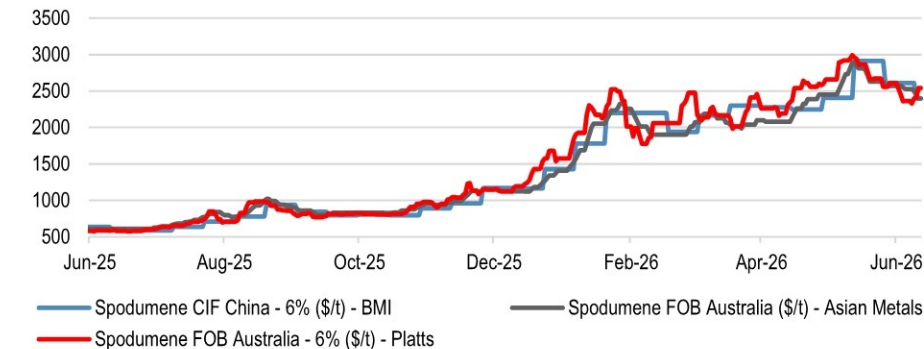
Source: Company data, Motor Intelligence.

Figure 13: Battery electric vehicle sales – EU



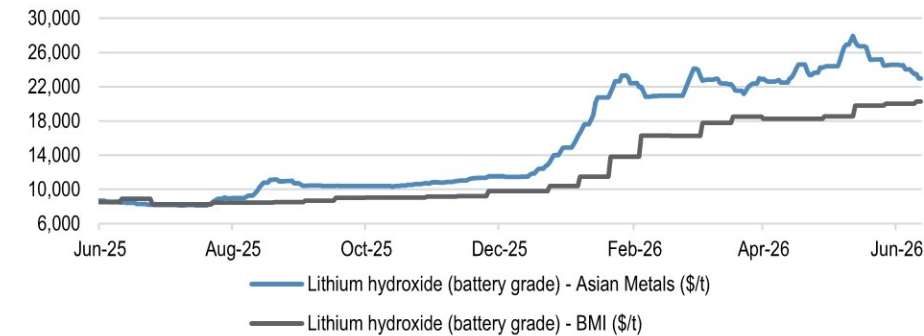
Source: Company data, Motor Intelligence.

Figure 14: Lithium spodumene prices



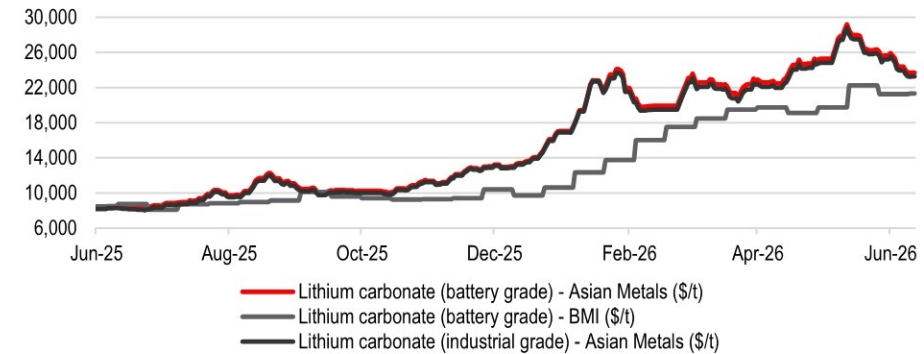
Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P.

Figure 15: Lithium hydroxide prices



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P.

Figure 16: Lithium carbonate prices



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P.

Companies Discussed in This Report (all prices in this report as of market close on 11 June 2026, unless otherwise indicated)
PLS Group(PLS.AX/A\$5.94/OW)

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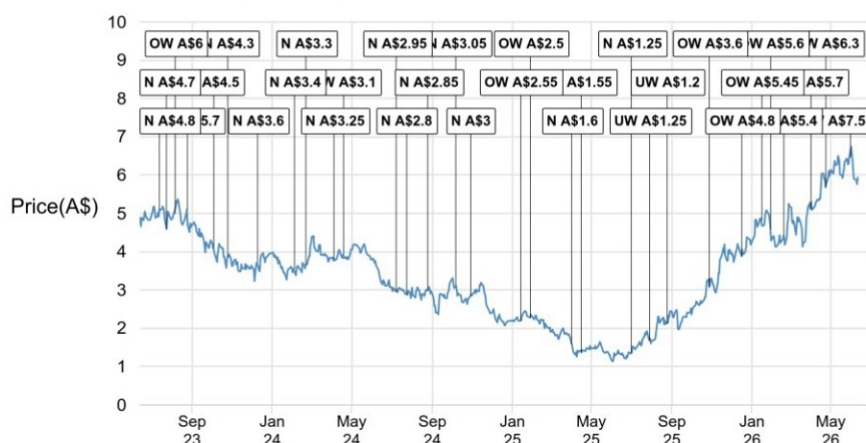
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PLS Group (PLS.AX, PLS AU) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (A\$)	Price Target (A\$)
14-Jul-23	N	5.09	4.8
25-Jul-23	N	4.59	4.7
07-Aug-23	OW	4.99	6
25-Aug-23	OW	5.11	5.7
04-Oct-23	N	4.09	4.5
26-Oct-23	N	3.88	4.3
11-Dec-23	N	3.71	3.6
05-Feb-24	N	3.55	3.4
22-Feb-24	N	3.66	3.3
05-Apr-24	N	3.82	3.25
19-Apr-24	UW	3.92	3.1
09-Jul-24	N	2.96	2.95
24-Jul-24	N	2.89	2.8
26-Aug-24	N	2.98	2.85
08-Oct-24	N	3.10	3.05
30-Oct-24	N	2.85	3
14-Jan-25	OW	2.20	2.55
29-Jan-25	OW	2.28	2.5
02-Apr-25	N	1.59	1.6
17-Apr-25	N	1.37	1.55
02-Jul-25	N	1.36	1.25
30-Jul-25	UW	1.68	1.25
25-Aug-25	UW	2.11	1.2
29-Oct-25	OW	3.08	3.6
17-Dec-25	OW	3.88	4.8
16-Jan-26	OW	4.83	5.45
30-Jan-26	OW	4.59	5.6
19-Feb-26	OW	4.42	5.4
01-Apr-26	OW	5.12	5.7
24-Apr-26	OW	5.68	6.3
01-Jun-26	OW	6.46	7.5

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